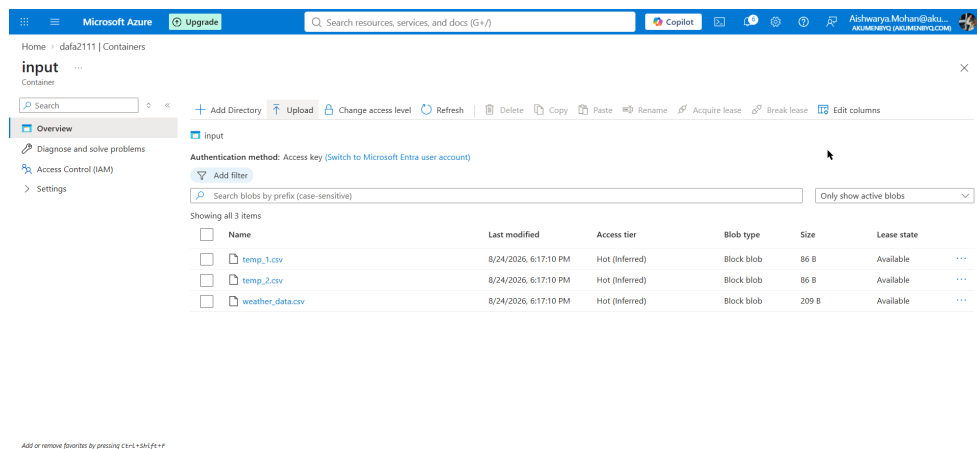
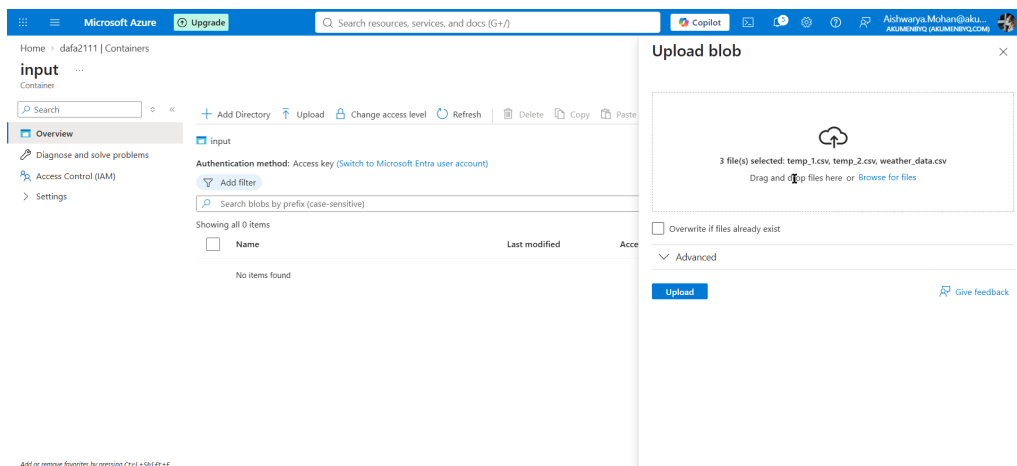
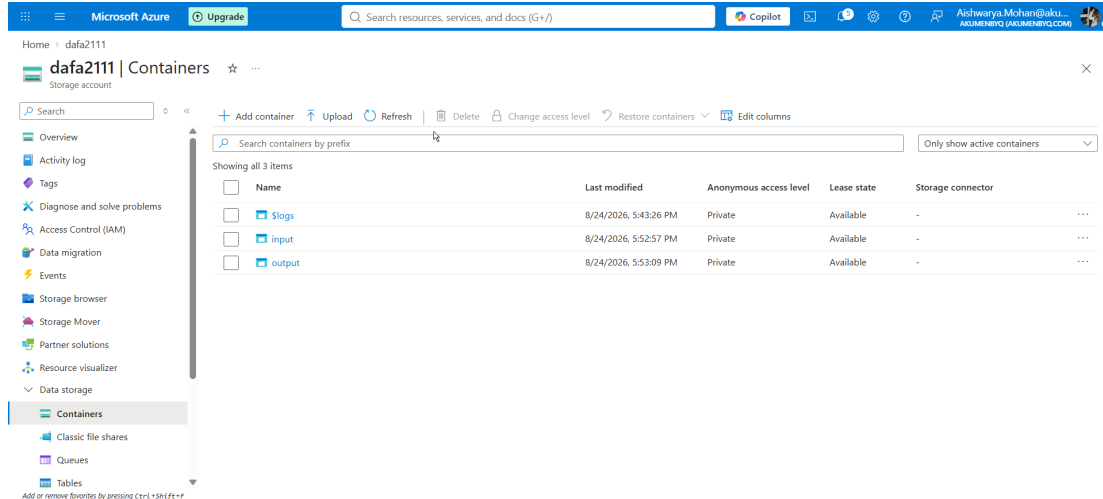


Azure Data Factory – Control Flow

Get Metadata → ForEach → If Condition
Screenshot Project (Minimal Text)

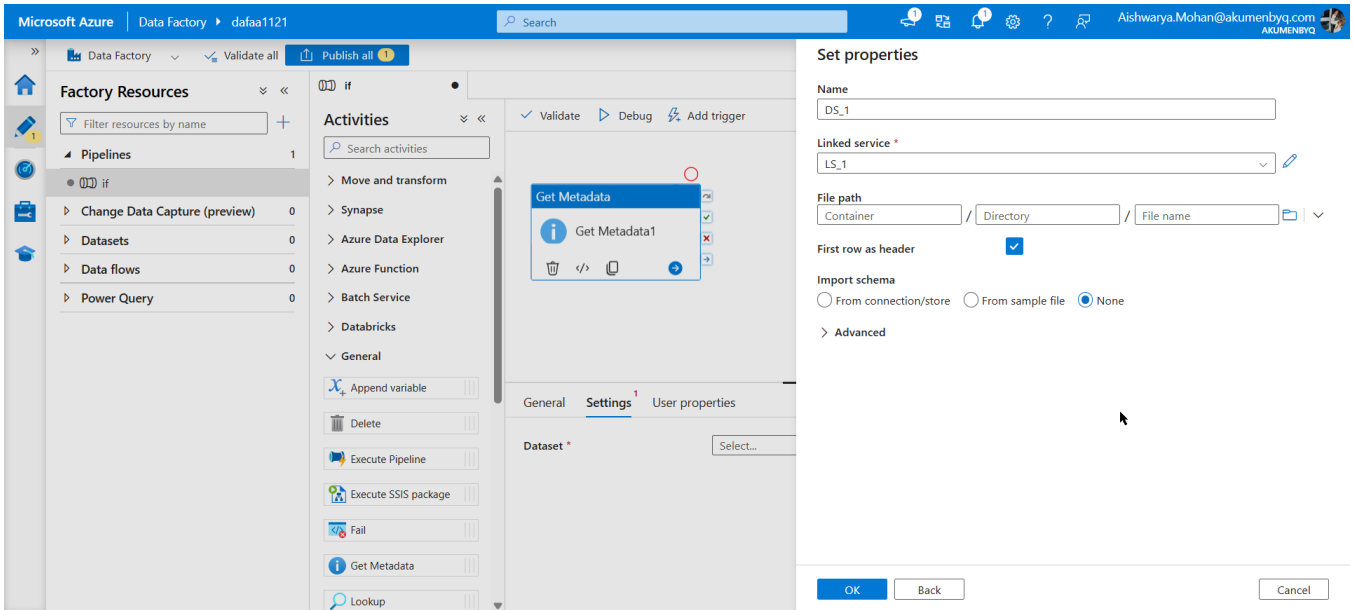
① Storage Setup

Create containers **input** & **output** → Upload 3 files to input

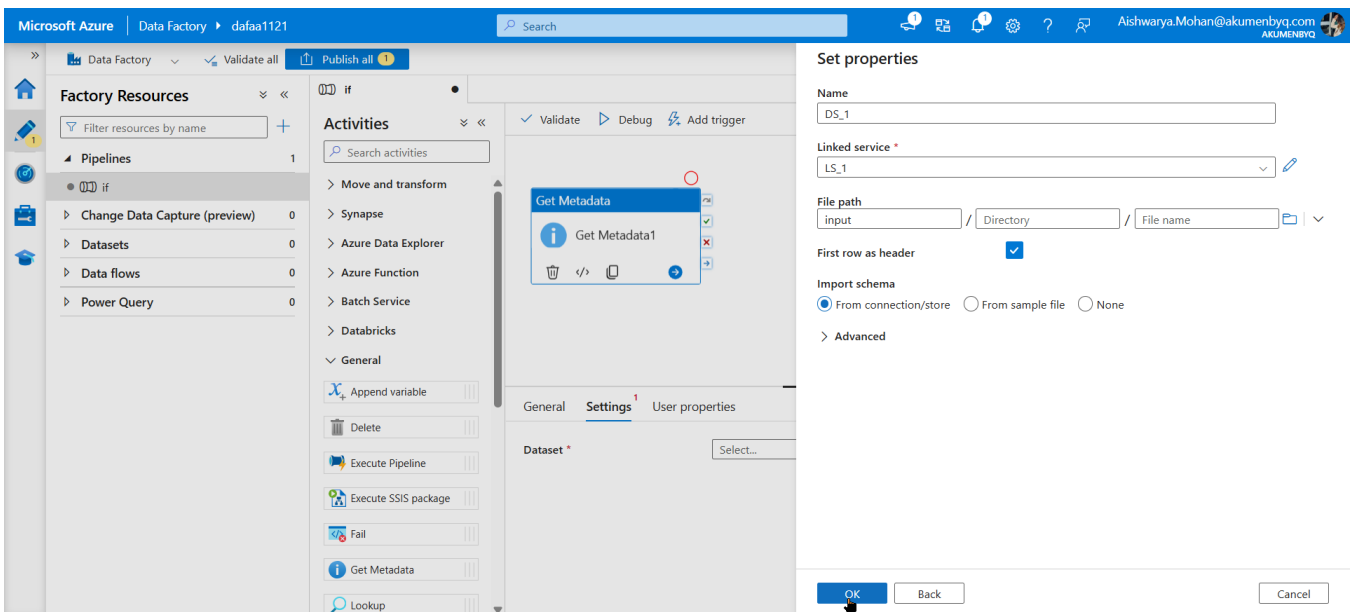


② Get Metadata Activity

Dataset DS_1 → Container = input | Field list = Child items



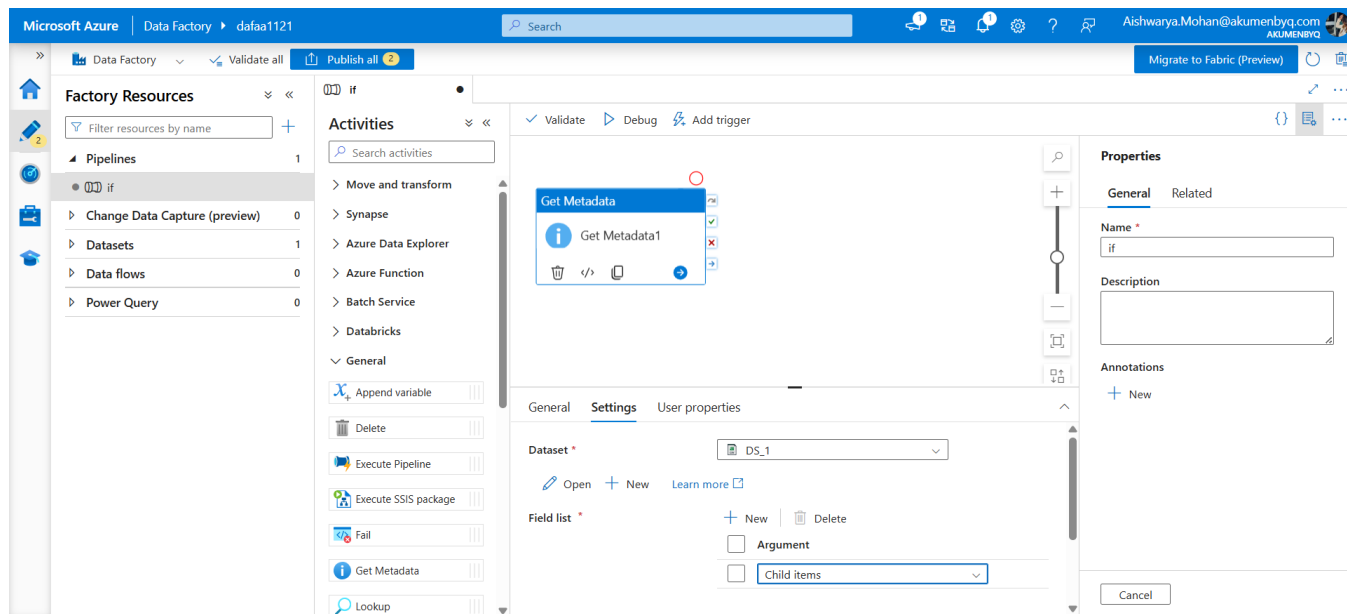
Create dataset DS_1 linked to input container



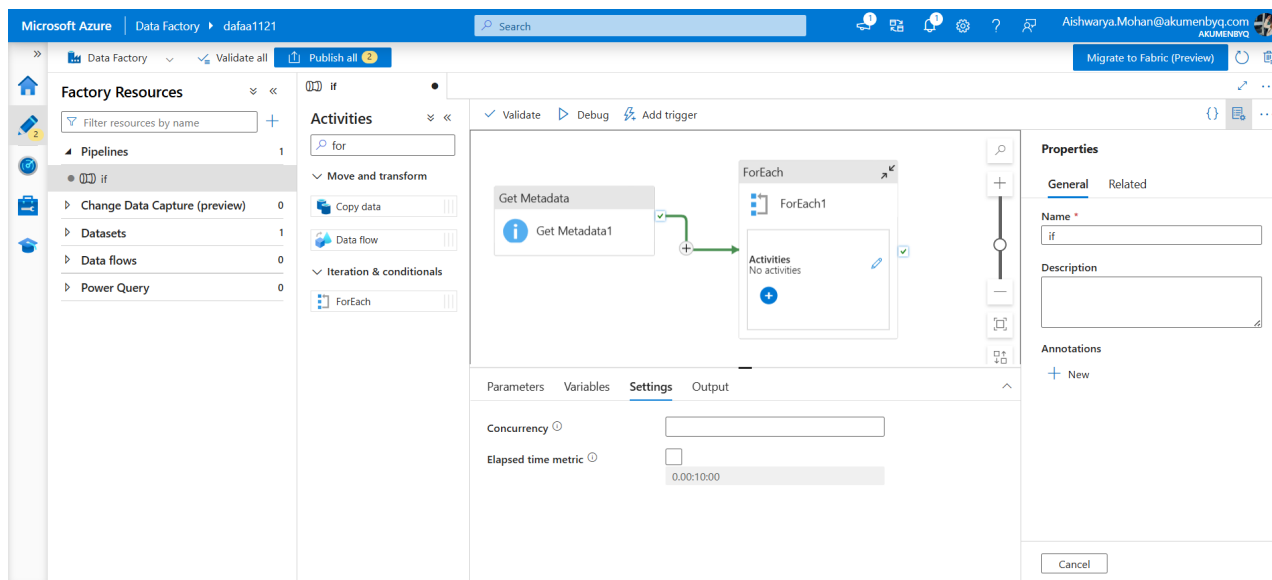
File path set to input | Import schema = From connection/store

③ ForEach + If Condition

Items = @activity('Get Metadata1').output.childItems
Expression = @contains(item().name,'temp')



Get Metadata1 connected → Field list = Child items



ForEach1 added after Get Metadata1

④ ForEach Settings + Expression

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Factory Resources

- Pipelines
- if
- Change Data Capture (preview)
- Datasets
- Data flows
- Power Query

Activities

- for
- Move and transform
 - Copy data
 - Data flow
- Iteration & conditionals
 - ForEach

General Settings Activities (0) User properties

Sequential ☐

Batch count

Items *

This property should be parameterized.

Add dynamic content (Alt+Shift+D)

Properties

General Related

Name *

Description

Annotations

+ New

Cancel

Items property must be parameterized

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Factory Resources

- Pipelines
- if
- Change Data Capture (preview)
- Datasets
- Data flows
- Power Query

Activities

- for
- Move and transform
 - Copy data
 - Data flow
- Iteration & conditionals
 - ForEach

General Settings Activities (0) User properties

Sequential ☐

Batch count

Items *

This property should be parameterized.

Add dynamic content (Alt+Shift+D)

Pipeline expression builder

Add dynamic content below using any combination of expressions, functions and system variables.

Clear contents

Activity outputs Parameters System variables Functions Variables

Get Metadata1
Get Metadata1 activity output

Get Metadata1 childItems
List of subfolders and files in the given folder

Get Metadata1 exists
Whether a file, folder, or table exists

Get Metadata1 itemName
Name of the file or folder

OK Cancel

Expression builder → select childItems

⑤ Add If Condition inside ForEach

This screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' with a count of 1. The main canvas displays a pipeline with a 'Get Metadata' activity followed by a 'ForEach' activity named 'ForEach1'. The 'Add trigger' dialog is open, showing the 'If' condition type. The 'Items' field is populated with '@activity('Get Metadata1').output.chi...'. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with the name 'if' and a description field.

Search & drag If Condition inside ForEach activities

This screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface after adding an 'If Condition' activity inside the 'ForEach' activity. The 'If Condition' activity is now visible within the 'ForEach1' activity's 'Activities' pane. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with the name 'If Condition1' and a description field. The 'Activity state' is set to 'Activated'.

If Condition1 appears inside ForEach

⑥ True / False Branches with Set Variable

True → Set variable temp = True
False → Set variable weather = False

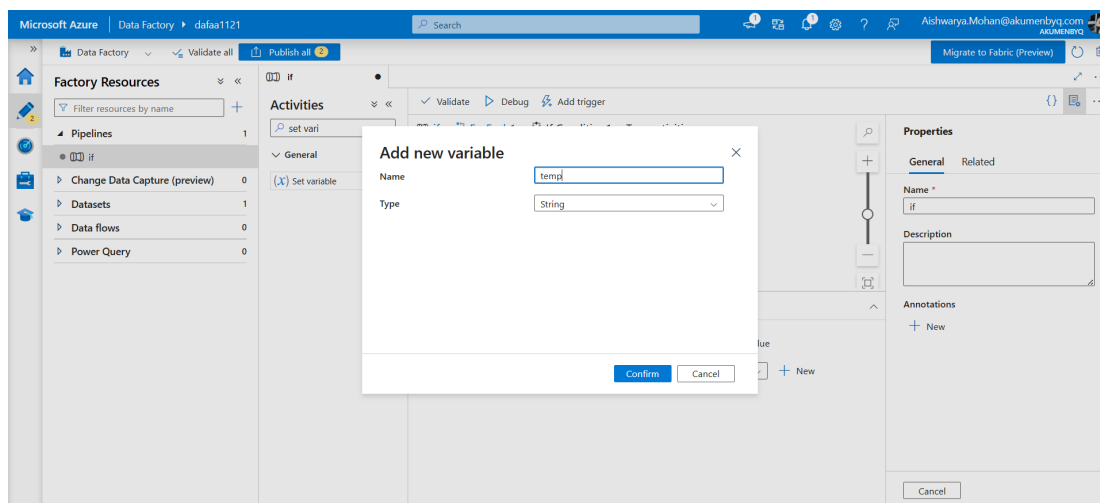
The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' and 'if'. The 'Activities' pane shows 'Move and transform' and 'Iteration & conditionals'. The main canvas displays a pipeline with a 'Get Metadata' activity followed by a 'ForEach' activity. The 'if' activity is expanded, showing a 'Get Metadata' activity and a 'ForEach' activity. The 'if' activity is currently set to 'if' and has a 'Description' field. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'if' activity's properties, including 'Name' and 'Description'.

Expression property → Add dynamic content

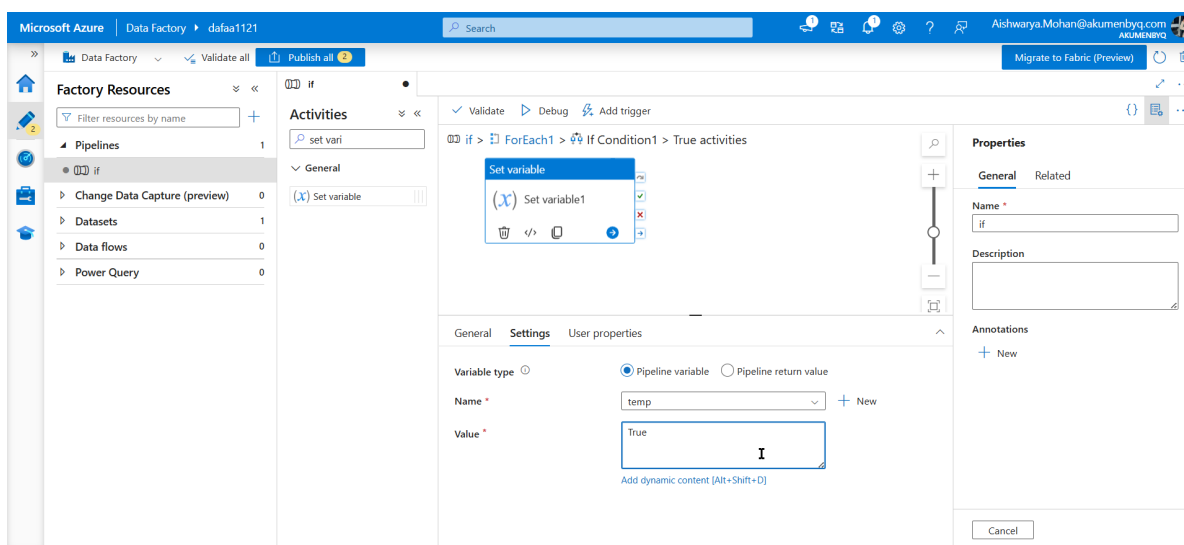
The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface with the 'Pipeline expression builder' dialog open. The dialog is titled 'Pipeline expression builder' and contains the text 'Add dynamic content below using any combination of expressions, functions and system variables.' The expression '@contains(item().name, 'temp')' is entered in the text area. The 'ForEach iterator' tab is selected, and the 'Current item' is 'ForEach1'. The 'OK' button is highlighted.

@contains(item().name,'temp')

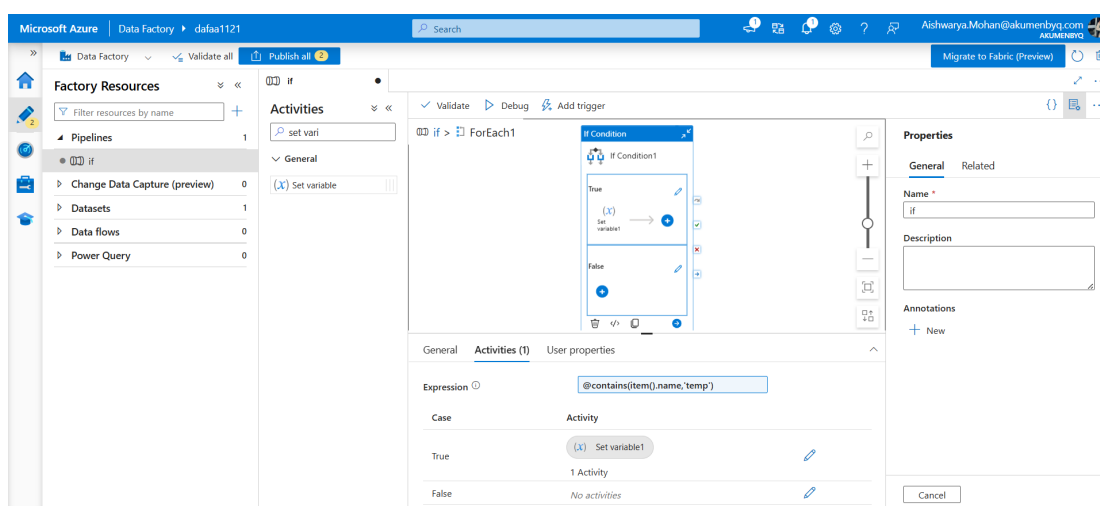
⑦ Create Variables & Set Values



Add new variable: temp (String)



True branch → Set variable1 → Value = True



If Condition shows True: Set variable1 | False: empty

⑧ False Branch Set Variable

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory editor interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' with 1 item, 'Datasets' with 1 item, 'Data flows' with 0 items, and 'Power Query' with 0 items. The main canvas displays an 'if' activity with two branches. The 'False' branch is selected, and the 'Set variable' activity is configured with the following properties:

- Variable type:** Pipeline variable
- Name:** weather
- Value:** False

The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with the Name 'if' and a description field.

False branch → Set variable2 → weather = False

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory editor interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' with 1 item, 'Datasets' with 1 item, 'Data flows' with 0 items, and 'Power Query' with 0 items. The main canvas displays an 'if' activity with two branches. The 'True' branch is selected, and the 'Set variable' activity is configured with the following properties:

- Expression:** @contains(item().name,'temp')
- Case:** Activity
- True:** 1 Activity
- False:** 1 Activity

The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with the Name 'if' and a description field.

Both True & False branches now have Set variable

⑨ Debug Result (Set Variable version)

All activities Succeeded

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface for a pipeline named 'if' in the workspace 'dafa1121'. The pipeline is in a 'Succeeded' state, and the 'Output' tab of the 'Activities' pane shows the following data:

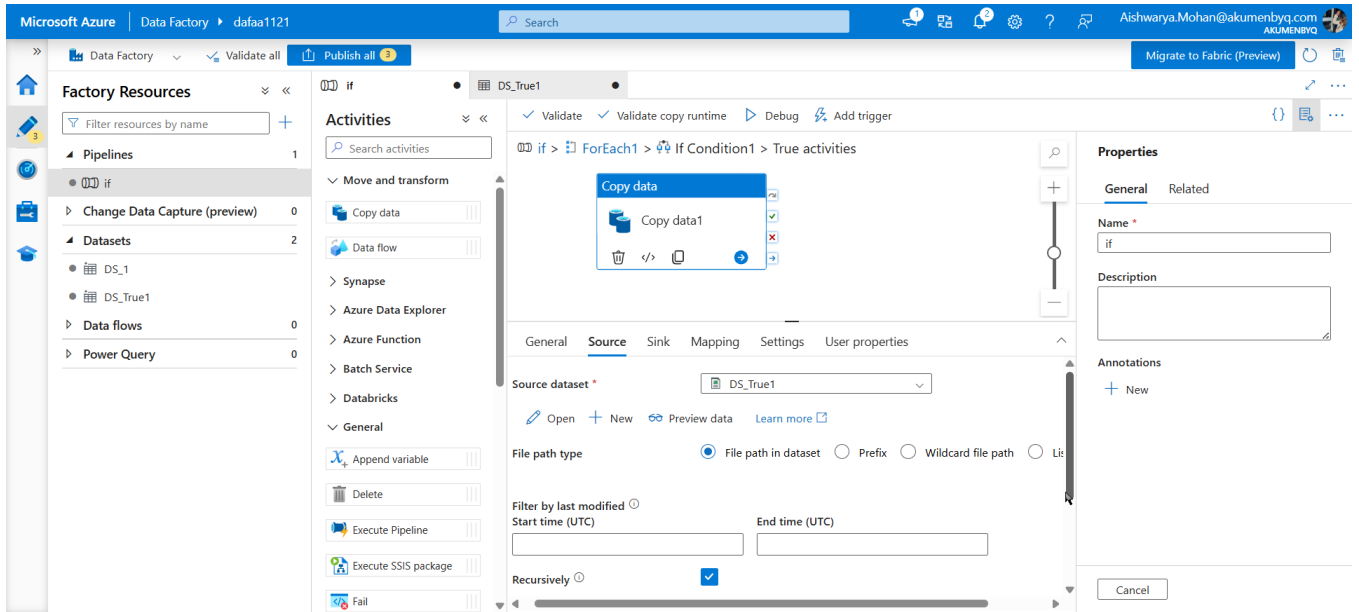
Activity name	Activity status	Activity name	Run start	Duration
Set variable2	Succeeded	Set variable	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	Les
Set variable1	Succeeded	Set variable	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	Les
Set variable1	Succeeded	Set variable	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	Les
If Condition1	Succeeded	If Condition	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	2s
If Condition1	Succeeded	If Condition	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	2s
If Condition1	Succeeded	If Condition	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	2s
ForEach1	Succeeded	ForEach	8/24/2026, 6:49:35 PM	4s
Get Metadata1	Succeeded	Get Metadata	8/24/2026, 6:49:16 PM	18s

The pipeline diagram shows a 'Get Metadata' activity (Get Metadata1) followed by a 'ForEach' loop (ForEach1) containing an 'If Condition' (If Condition1) and a 'Set variable' activity (Set variable).

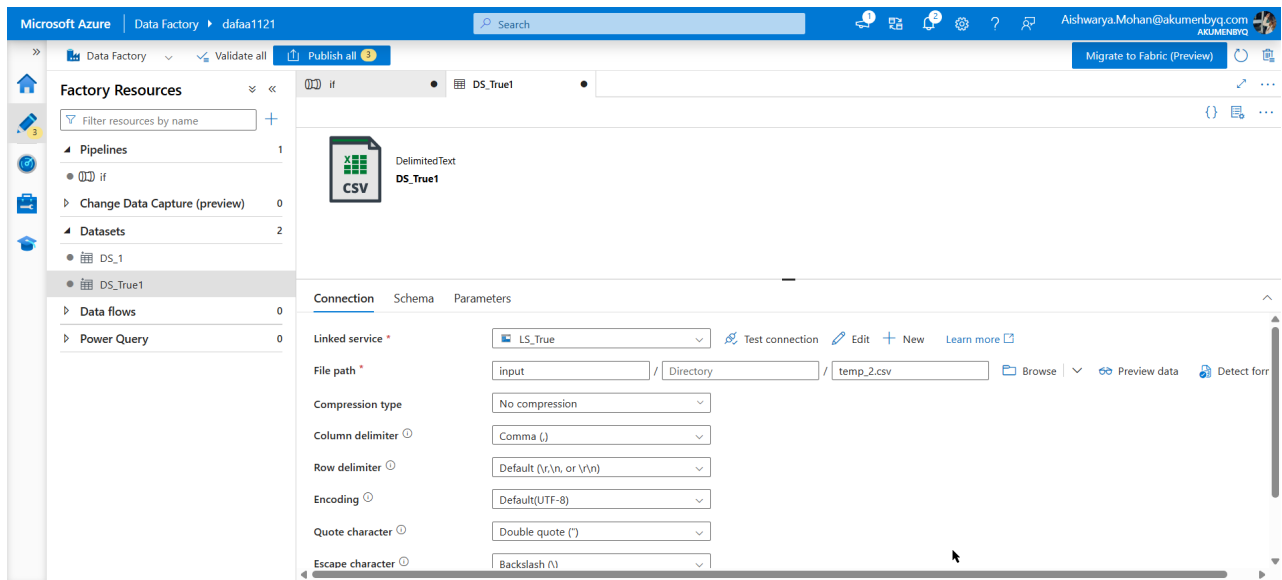
Pipeline run output – Get Metadata, ForEach, If Condition, Set variables all green

10 Replace Set Variable with Copy Data

True → Copy data1 | False → Copy data2



Copy data1 inside True activities – Source = DS_True1



Dataset DS_True1 points to input container

Final Pipeline with Copy Activities

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Factory Resources

- Pipelines: 1
 - if
- Change Data Capture (preview): 0
- Datasets: 4
 - DS_1
 - DS_False
 - DS_False1
 - DS_True1
- Data flows: 0
- Power Query: 0

Activities

- Move and transform
 - Copy data
 - Data flow
- Synapse
- Azure Data Explorer
- Azure Function
- Batch Service
- Databricks
- General
 - Append variable
 - Delete
 - Execute Pipeline
 - Execute SSIS package
 - Fail

Properties

General

Name: if

Description:

Annotations: + New

Activity state: Validated

Pipeline validation output

Your pipeline has been validated.
No errors were found.

If Condition1 → True: Copy data1 | False: Copy data2

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Factory Resources

- Pipelines: 1
 - if
- Change Data Capture (preview): 0
- Datasets: 4
 - DS_1
 - DS_False
 - DS_False1
 - DS_True1
- Data flows: 0
- Power Query: 0

Activities

- Move and transform
 - Copy data
 - Data flow
- Synapse
- Azure Data Explorer
- Azure Function
- Batch Service
- Databricks
- General
 - Append variable
 - Delete
 - Execute Pipeline
 - Execute SSIS package
 - Fail

Properties

General

Name: if

Description:

Annotations: + New

Activity state: Validated

Pipeline validation output

Your pipeline has been validated.
No errors were found.

Pipeline validated successfully – No errors found

■ Pipeline Run & Output Container

Files copied to output container

Debug run – All Copy data & If Condition activities Succeeded

Name	Last modified	Access tier	Blob type	Size	Lease state
Pokemon.csv	8/24/2026, 7:10:04 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	4.6 KiB	Available
temp_2.csv	8/24/2026, 7:18:41 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	86 B	Available

output container now contains the copied files

Name	Last modified	Access tier	Blob type	Size	Lease state
Pokemon.csv	8/24/2026, 7:18:40 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	4.6 KiB	Available
temp_1.csv	8/24/2026, 6:17:10 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	86 B	Available
temp_2.csv	8/24/2026, 7:12:45 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	86 B	Available
weather_data.csv	8/24/2026, 6:17:10 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	209 B	Available

input container still has original files + Pokemon.csv

Logic: Get Metadata → ForEach → If contains('temp') → True: Copy | False: Copy